

Chapter 84-6

While waiting for Liang Shi to wash up, Xu Qingzhu laid out the things she had bought from outside that morning. There were some simple cosmetics—she had only bought lipstick and sunscreen.

This tourist area didn't sell a complete selection of products, and they were all off-brand items she didn't dare put on her face casually. Only the lipstick and sunscreen were brands she had used before, so she only bought those.

She sprayed on sunscreen in front of the mirror, then applied lipstick.

Liang Shi quickly changed and came out, wearing the same style dress as Xu Qingzhu, but in light blue.

Both of them had good figures, and they could make even such ordinary maxi dresses look incredibly alluring.

The same style in different colors looked very much like couple's outfits, and the knit cardigans on top were also matching.

Liang Shi asked her: "It's already autumn—aren't you cold?"

"Didn't I buy leggings?" Xu Qingzhu said: "Put them on. Besides, the temperature by the sea is quite high during the day. It only gets cold at night."

At its peak, the day-night temperature difference could reach over ten degrees.

Liang Shi had her phone announce the weather and found that it was indeed warmer here than in the city, reaching twenty-three degrees.

She walked over and noticed there was also lipstick on the cabinet. She said in surprise: "You even bought this?"

"Mm." Xu Qingzhu said: "Essential for improving complexion. I didn't sleep well last night."

Liang Shi's face immediately flashed with panic. "Huh?"

She might as well have written on her face—Does this have something to do with me? Is it my fault? Did something happen?

Xu Qingzhu chuckled softly, twisted open the lipstick to compare it against Liang Shi's skin tone, then closed the cap again. "It has nothing to do with you."

Liang Shi: "..."

She was still on edge.

Xu Qingzhu handed her a hair tie. "Teacher Liang, can you help me tie my hair?"

Liang Shi: "Huh?"

"If you can't, then forget it." Xu Qingzhu put the hair tie back on the table. After what happened last night when she was drunk, Liang Shi, who was feeling incredibly guilty, immediately picked it up. "I can."

The black hair tie was looped around Liang Shi's wrist, paired with the bracelet Xu Qingzhu had bid on before. The silver and black colors complemented each other beautifully.

Liang Shi asked Xu Qingzhu for a comb, but Xu Qingzhu said the combs here were too soft and would hurt her scalp when combing, so she asked her to use her ten fingers as a comb instead.

Liang Shi's slender fingers slipped into Xu Qingzhu's hair, gently and slowly, as if giving her a scalp massage.

Liang Shi gathered her hair in her hand and asked if she wanted it lower or higher.

"Lower." Xu Qingzhu said.

"Two loops or three loops?" Liang Shi asked.

Generally speaking, two loops would be too loose, and three loops would be tight.

"Just tie it however you normally do." Xu Qingzhu said: "It doesn't matter."

Liang Shi: "...Alright."

In the end, Liang Shi still tied it with three loops, but she moved the hair tie back a bit so it wouldn't dig too much into her scalp.

A few strands of hair were left loose at the front, looking pure and beautiful.

Xu Qingzhu handed the sunscreen to Liang Shi, but halfway through, she pulled her hand back. "Should I help you?"

Liang Shi: "...How about I do it myself?"

Xu Qingzhu changed it to a declarative statement, opening the cap. "I'll help you."

Liang Shi: "..."

Xu Qingzhu squeezed sunscreen into her own palm, then dotted it on several spots on Liang Shi's face. Her soft hands landed on her face and spread it out.

The height difference between them wasn't actually that big, but Xu Qingzhu always felt uncomfortable when applying it for her—her arm had to be raised too high. So she said softly: "Bend down."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi obediently bent down, making it more comfortable for her to work.

Delicate fingers glided across the skin of Liang Shi's face. Those fingers touched every inch of Liang Shi's face.

Liang Shi unconsciously pressed her lips together.

When Xu Qingzhu applied it to the corner of her lips, she suddenly asked in a matter-of-fact tone: "Did you feel your tongue was numb this morning?"

Liang Shi: "???"

Her pupils contracted. Her face seemed to say—Is this something that can be talked about?

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her. "Normal conversation. Is there a problem?"

Liang Shi: "...No."

In the education Liang Shi had received in the past, this kind of thing could only be kept in the dark. It was impossible to discuss it openly.

Especially since she liked girls—saying it out loud would get her mocked to death and secretly blacklisted.

But Xu Qingzhu said openly: "The base of my tongue feels a bit numb. The tip of my tongue seems to have been bitten through—it hurts a little."

"Huh?" Liang Shi was startled. "Where?"

Xu Qingzhu pressed her lips together but didn't show her. She just described it more precisely: "About a quarter of the way from the tip of my tongue."

Liang Shi: "..."

Xu Qingzhu said expressionlessly: "Don't bite with your tongue next time. Haven't you filmed kissing scenes before? If you bite, the tip of the tongue will bleed. It hurts."

Liang Shi: "..."

Her mind went blank, but she used sheer willpower to answer Xu Qingzhu's question. "I've never filmed real ones. They were all camera tricks."

In order to keep her distance from others, she had never dared to film real kissing scenes.

With male actors, that went without saying—she had never had kissing scenes with them!

She had mostly played the second female lead who loved but couldn't be with the male lead, or in urban dramas she played workplace roles. She had almost never acted in idol dramas.

The only BG¹ idol drama she had acted in, the male lead died at the beginning, and it was basically all flashbacks. The stories interspersed in their memories were all very slow-paced, like a dish simmered over low heat. There was only one kissing scene in it, on a morning when the first snow fell—the two of them were supposed to kiss while standing in the snow.

But that male lead had a girlfriend at the time, and the girlfriend was a rich, beautiful princess type who was extremely jealous, so they directly called in a body double to film with her.

She wasn't too happy about it either, so she directly discussed with the screenwriter to delete that kissing scene.

They didn't even hold hands.

After hearing this, Xu Qingzhu frowned. "That's unprofessional of you."

Liang Shi: "...I do all my own action scenes. Using camera tricks for kissing scenes isn't a big deal. How can that be considered unprofessional?"

Xu Qingzhu paused for a moment. "But that's creating dreams for the audience. Look at all those TV dramas we watched before—weren't they all real kisses?"

"That's not true. Several of them were obviously camera tricks." Liang Shi said: "Some even used body doubles—you could tell because the lip shape changed."

Xu Qingzhu: "...?"

"Money is too easy to earn in your industry." Xu Qingzhu clicked her tongue. "No respect for your own profession."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi huffed lightly. "If we're creating dreams for the audience, then we'd also have to stir up CP² during promotions. If it gets too much, we'd have to recreate scenes from the drama to give the audience their sugar³. As long as the audience doesn't move on, we can't break up the CP. Then what about our other projects?"

This actually stumped Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu thought for a moment. "Promote them together."

"That's too exhausting." Liang Shi said: "Actors are actors, characters are characters. Some things can only stay within the characters."

Xu Qingzhu felt she had a point, then steered the conversation back to before. "Then be more careful next time you kiss. Don't bite the tongue."

Liang Shi: "..."

There's going to be a next time?!

Footnotes:

¹ **BG (Boy-Girl)**: A term used in Chinese fan communities to refer to heterosexual romantic pairings, as opposed to BL (Boy's Love) or GL (Girl's Love).

² **CP (Coupling)**: Short for "couple pairing," referring to romantic pairings between actors or characters that fans ship together. "Stirring up CP" means deliberately creating romantic buzz between two people for publicity.

³ **Sugar (糖):** Internet slang for sweet, romantic moments between a shipped couple that fans enjoy. "Giving fans sugar" means providing romantic content or interactions that fans of the pairing want to see.